

Most often you're infected because of your own actions. Do you tend to click on links offering you "99% discount" on flights? If yes, you should scan your computer for spyware. These applications often use trickery to get you to install them, from fake system alert messages to buttons that say "cancel" when they really install spyware. Most spyware run as an application in the background as soon as you start your computer up, hogging RAM and processor power. They make your web browser slow by constantly opening pop-up ads. Sometimes they control your search results rendering your search engine useless. A very malicious spyware can record the words you type, your web browsing history, passwords and other private information.



Phishing for information

Mousetrapping

Don't you feel annoyed when you want to leave a web site and can't? This is often referred to as mousetrapping. Mousetrapping is a technique used to trap an unwilling visitor at an offending web site in order to gain maximum benefit from the one-time visit. Hackers copy code of legitimate web sites and add a bit of code that would redirect them to a completely different web site. Since the code mirrors the original web site they also end up in search engines thus a surfer can't tell if a link is bogus or not until he or she clicks on it. Thus you might click to get a great discount deal and might end up opening a porn site.

The attacker knows that the unwilling visitor will try to close the web site as soon as they see an offensive web site therefore they incorporate additional redirect code that prevents leaving, while using the visitor's clicks to generate revenue. This way when you click on "Back" or "Close", it begins a loop opening one offensive site or advertisement after another, popping up banner after banner in a cascade of windows. Although, this is fairly harmless, it can cause pretty embarrassing moments for you.

Network threats

Many people feel that their home network is at a low risk for attack. Especially in India, people think that no one bothers to hack networks but if you have a Wireless Access Point on your network you're at risk. If the ISP